

Meeting Minutes

Kick off Meeting for the formation of TWG for Housing Standards and Training

Date: 4 March 2016 Friday

Time: 2 - 4 pm

Location: HRRP Office, Jwagal

Lead/Chairperson/Focal Point: Jennifer D. Barenstein

Participants:

Kam for Sud- Daniel Pittet; Build Change- Noll Tufani; UNDP- Vivek Rawal; Prafulla Man Singh Pradhan, UNHABITAT; HRRP- Jennifer D. Barenstein, Om D. Rajopadhyaya, Arjun Koirala, Anil Maharjan, Jeny Shrestha, Loren Lockwood

Agendas

1. Discussion and inputs on the proposed TOR for TWG for Housing Standards and Training
2. Suggestion for the formation of the Technical Working Group

Discussion

In addition to what has been raised as issues in the draft ToR there are some other issues that need to be discussed and solutions worked out.

- 200,000 will not be sufficient to construct a new house.
- How the people can repair their houses needs to be worked out.
- What salvage materials can be used? How would the house owner know about it?
- Many of the houses have good foundation. Who will tell the house owners about it and how to check whether the foundation is good enough?
- There are houses that can be retrofitted. Whether retrofitting would cost more than new construction? How the TA for retrofitting can be provided?

Training

- Since a large number of masons are to be produced, question arises how this can be done.
- How the training gets delivered in those areas where there are no POs.
- Different type construction materials are available in different places. Therefore training based on standard materials may not be applicable to all places
- Housing reconstruction requires at least 2 masons per house for 2 months, each VDC requires at least 80-90 masons. Hence, there is a need for development of large scale training program system - NRA could initiate the development of such system, where POs could also contribute

- Major emphasis has been given to skill enhancement of existing masons for earthquake resistant construction, as it directly relates to the rolling out of subsidy and the need for safer construction
- Important to fill the area wise gap of the required number of artisans for housing reconstruction
- As the gap is not likely to be homogenous, an option could be to develop minimalist approach for basic level trainings from Partner Organizations to cover all the areas
 - Need to assess the impact
 - Can Partner Organizations afford to have a second level of training afterwards?
- Need to Target three major groups:
 1. Skill enhancement of available artisans,
 2. Training for new artisans,
 3. Training for migrant artisans
- 4W monitoring would be an important medium to assess the area wise gaps in training activities
- Need to rematch available trainings with targeted participants
- POs are conducting different types of training. It is also important to have uniformity in training processes. For subsidy it is important to use a mason trained on earthquake technology.
- Considering the variety of training activity and their specific requirements, it is important to clearly state the type of training that is being referred to
- Need to consider training for other artisans (carpenters, plumbers, bar benders etc.) as they are very much linked with livelihood aspects
- It is hard for local people to afford skilled masons
- With the probable prohibition in allowing financial assistance to reconstruct houses, POs are trying to relocate their funds to training related activities. The proposed TWGs would thus have a major role in balancing between the need of the NRA and the POs; and ultimately the need of the local people
- Artisan screening for training: On the field, in most of the cases, only around 20-25% of the trainees that undergo skill enhancement training are able to take up the earthquake safe housing reconstruction activities, ultimately only 70% of wards have at least 1 skilled artisan

Resource Center

- Need to assess the probable impacts due to the establishment of resource center (eg. Impact on livelihood)
 - o Human nature – People would follow market behavior, if the skilled mason comes down to the resource center for more opportunity and high pay compared to remote area there may be no skilled masons left in remote areas.
- Training may be more appropriate to provide in VDCs than in resource centers

Technical Assistance, Norms and Standards

- There needs to be clarity on what sort of technical service and information needs to be disseminated among the affected households (eg. DUDBC Design catalogues not for the reference of the Homeowners)
- Repair and retrofitting depends on time, finances and availability of skilled manpower- hence, there is a need to develop a prioritization list of major items that need attention

- A mechanism of incentive may be required in order to hold the technical person and trained mason in every ward
- Optimize and rationalize the technical standards
- Produce and disseminate what minimal needs to be complied in housing reconstruction
- UNDP has submitted retrofitting guidelines to DUDBC, even for adobe building- not yet approved
- Check list for supervision and inspection needs to be prepared

Technical Working Group

- Need to discuss with NRA regarding its comprehensive framework for Training and Housing standards for the TWG and include POs that have Time, Resources and Experience in related disciplines
- Major Role of TWG would be:
 - Needs assessment : Issues to be discussed and identification of outputs to be produced
 - Gap Analysis in terms of coverage, coordination among implementing agencies and Training strategy from POs
 - Development of Training module and working procedure with NRA & POs
 - Development of training strategy, delivery approach and schedule
- Further, TWG could support in
 - Clarifying issues led by complete change in training approach from POs due to NRA policies
 - Setting up of rapid response team consisting of selected POs that are willing to support the VDCs with lesser/ no training activities
 - Collect the essential framework from POs for Training and Housing Standards
 - Estimation of resources required to support activities related to housing reconstruction , including training and financial assistance
 - Development of a minimum checklist for to assess the training needs and contextualize the training program as per the requirement of the specific area

Action Points

1. ToRs for both the TWGs would be shared among the present Partner Organizations for their feedback
2. The revised ToRs would be shared among all the POs
3. A meeting of POs would be called and TWGs formed
4. The TWGs would discuss further and finalize the ToR

Next Meeting

Yet to be decided

Meeting Participants List/Attendance Sheet

Org	Name	Designation	Phone	Email
HRRP	Jennifer D. Barenstein	Team Leader	9801127843	jennifer.duyne@hrrpnepal.org
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HRRP	Anil Maharjan	Technical Officer (Housing	9803875040	anil.maharjan@hrrpnepal.org
HRRP	Jeny Shrestha	Technical Officer (Training)	9841408545	jeny.shrestha@hrrpnepal.org

Annex 1:

Comment from Mr. Vivek Rawal via email (vivek@peopleincentre.org) March 16, 2016

1. Regarding TWG on Training, the ToR mentions certification and quality assurance mechanism as an output. I feel certification process may become too ambitious where comprehensive test mechanism may have to be instituted. This may be done by CTEVT on long term basis. I remember some suggestion by our POs that we need not wait for reconstruction work to be taken on by certified masons, as it could cause many issues. We should write now just aim to train masons who are aware of construction details for minimum compliance as required by DUDBC/ MoUD. So I will suggest modifying the expected outs accordingly.
2. CTEVT and DUDBC need to be taken on board if we have to be successful. They should not think we are preparing some curriculum independent of them. In fact this process should complement their work and this need to be clearly articulated.
3. Regarding ToR of TWG on technical standards, again we need to articulate and establish reference with DUDBC in a positive manner and mention that developing guidelines and manuals in people friendly format is to complement DUDBC work. I think it is important for this TWG to help NRA/ DUDBC in identifying the appropriate mechanism of fast track approval of technologies.
4. The gaps in the current process should be identified in a positive manner so that including DUDBC in the technical standard TWG can take place. It should not be communicated that it is a parallel process.

Annex 2:

**Comment from Mr. Noll Tufani via email (noll@buildchange.org)
March 21, 2016**

Please find below Build Change's comments on the Training TOR.

Overall, the training TOR content looks good, but I think it is overly optimistic with a 1 month timeline. The sharing of materials and the development of a serious and mutually agreed curriculum would likely take at least 2 months of full time work for a team of 2-4.

This doesn't mean that training could not happen, people could start training with a rough outline. This is where Build Change's builder skills guideline becomes a very useful resource (attached). It can be used as a starting point, and can already be shared with all PO's as a general guideline for developing their training activities. It doesn't include training content, just an outline list of the minimum skills we believe necessary to build a disaster-resistant house.

The TWG could share this with all PO's now as a supposed output of it's first meetings, then go on to develop curriculum content in it's own time based on this outline that it can share at a later date.

It would also be good to promote the fact that skill development or "training" is a process, not a time-bound activity. In other words, the skills needed to build a house are developed over time, not over 5 or 8 days. PO's should feel comfortable about this. Following this logic, the TWG's could take the following stance on training:

- Agencies can conduct an introductory 5 or 8 day training following the DUDBC curricula or other developed by each PO (some of the skills in our competency list can be developed here but by no means all)
- The introductory training includes an assessment of builders (or even a self assessment of builders) that helps classify them by level of experience and existing skill. (Build Change can help the TWG develop these assessments)
- These builders are then put to work in their different capacities. PO's provide them with on-the-job training as needed and track their skill development over time, using the competency list.
- At some point in the future, these builders will have developed all of the competencies necessary to work without supervision (anywhere between 3 months and a year depending on the skill of each builder).
- PO's can track progress using the database attached.

This is TWG/TOR is a really good opportunity to:

- Help PO's Differentiate skill development from training (and for PO's to feel comfortable with people not knowing everything after 5 days)
- Push better quality skill development programs (on-the-job, progressive skill development tracking)
- Have a very large impact

Best regards,

Noll

Noll TUFANI

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